

Levelling Up White Paper

Published in 2022 under Johnson

Promises include

Pay and employment to improve, with one globally important city (for this Bristol?)

Increasing R&D outside SE by 40% w/ stimulated innovation

Improving public transport connectivity

Increasing maths reading and writing skills to 90% meeting standards, up by 1/3 in worst areas

Increase in numbers doing high skills training, meaning 200,000 more completing training annually

Pride in place will increase by 2030, judged on satisfaction with town centre, local culture, etc.

Stoke-on-Trent

[Stoke-on-Trent City Council backs updated £812m investment plan - BBC News](#)

Traditional pottery and ceramics industry

Had coal mining, last closed in 1990s

Steel production ended in 2002

Potteries still remain but to less of a degree

New 2026 masterplan, focusing on reusing brownfield sites for new housing

Higher number of economically inactive and unqualified people than national average

Future Council Prospectus [FUTURE 100 PROSPECTUS web.pdf](#)

Barnsley

[How a Tuscan vision took Barnsley back from the brink of disaster - BBC News](#)

Traditional glass-making town, also coal mines all around

2002 initial regeneration plans started

Tuscan hill joke publicity thing ended up offering a bit of free PR

Big idea - don't compete with nearby hubs, go local

Build a market hub, with adjoining cinema, bowling alley, other local and national traders

Rebuilt every secondary school and range of new youth centres opened